Checkpoint 3 · Problem Definition & Personas

Target Personas, As-Is Journey Maps & How-Might-We Statements | INT335 Design Thinking

1. Primary User Personas

Persona 1: Aarav Sharma (The Distressed Hosteller)	20 Years · B.Tech CSE (Hosteller)
Demographics & Goals: • Lives in BH-4; relies on scientific calculator and RFID smart card. • Wants to recover lost items quickly without academic interruption. • Values privacy and fears scams.	**Pain Points & Frustrations:** • Posts on unofficial WhatsApp groups, leading to fake claims. • Waste hours walking across 600 acres during exam week. • Reluctance to surrender personal phone number to strangers.
Representative Quote: *"I lost my calculator 2 days before exams. Posting on social media brought 4 fake claimants and 0 calculators."*	

Persona 2: Priya Patel (The Hurried Finder & Day Scholar)	21 Years · B.Tech Biotech (Day Scholar)
Demographics & Goals: • Commutes from Jalandhar; tight schedule between lectures. • Has good intentions to return items found in corridors. • Wants an effortless handover that takes less than 2 minutes.	**Pain Points & Frustrations:** • Cannot carry found heavy items home or miss university bus. • Doesn't know which security desk has jurisdiction over the area. • Fears being accused of theft if seen holding someone else's item.
Representative Quote: *"I found a wallet near the cafeteria, but I had a bus in 5 minutes. Where was I supposed to leave it safely?"*	

2. As-Is User Journey Map (Current Campus Reality)

Stage	User Action	Emotional State	Friction / Failure Point
1. Loss Event	Realizes calculator is missing after leaving Block 34 lab.	Shock & Panic (-2)	No immediate idea where or when it slipped out.
2. Search	Re-traces steps through 3 blocks under extreme heat.	Exhaustion (-3)	Classroom is locked or occupied by another batch.
3. Broadcast	Posts photo & phone number on WhatsApp / Instagram.	Anxiety & Fear (-4)	Harassment, spam calls, and opportunistic fake claimants.
4. Enquiry	Asks security desk; guard checks unlabeled cardboard box.	Frustration (-3)	Guard has 6 identical items; cannot verify ownership.
5. Resignation	Gives up recovery; repurchases item at full market cost.	Defeat & Loss (-5)	Permanent financial loss and lack of trust in campus support.

3. Point of View (POV) & Prioritized 'How Might We' Statements

Point of View (POV) Statement:

"University students carrying essential academic belongings across a 600-acre campus need an authenticated, privacy-preserving recovery channel without exposing their personal phone numbers because informal social media groups invite fraudulent claims, spam harassment, and permanent property loss."

HMW #1 (Core)	**How might we verify genuine ownership instantly** without exposing personal phone numbers or confidential student identification to public boards?
HMW #2 (Finder)	**How might we make reporting a found item effortless (under 60 seconds)** so hurried students drop it off before their next class?
HMW #3 (Admin)	**How might we empower campus security guards to match and hand over items** with zero confusion, language barriers, or paper registry logs?